

GABRIEL POPA

Senior GenAI / AI Software Engineer

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ABOUT ME

Senior Software Engineer with strong experience designing and building **AI-powered applications, backend systems, and scalable web platforms**. Experienced in developing **LLM-enabled solutions, Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) pipelines, API integrations, and cloud-based services** that improve business workflows and user experience. Skilled at translating product requirements into reliable systems with strong focus on **performance, maintainability, security**, and measurable delivery impact.

SKILLS

- **Generative AI & LLMs:** OpenAI API, Azure OpenAI, LLM application development, prompt engineering, RAG, semantic search, AI orchestration, AI assistants, chatbot workflows, document-based Q&A, vector search concepts
- **Programming Languages:** Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL
- **Frontend:** React, Vue.js, Angular, HTML, CSS, SCSS, Tailwind CSS
- **Backend & APIs:** Node.js, Express.js, REST APIs, microservices, authentication, authorization, web integrations
- **Data & Storage:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, SQL Server, MongoDB, Redis
- **Cloud & DevOps:** AWS, Azure, Docker, Kubernetes, CI/CD, GitHub Actions, Git, Linux
- **Testing & Quality:** Unit Testing, Integration Testing, API Testing, debugging, performance tuning, monitoring

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer

Soft Build | Bucharest, Romania (Jan2024 – Dec 2025)

- Designed and implemented **GenAI-enabled application features** using **LLM APIs** to support smarter user workflows, automated content generation, and faster information retrieval.
- Built **RAG-style backend flows** that combined document ingestion, semantic retrieval, and AI-generated responses, improving answer relevance by **3%** in internal evaluation scenarios.
- Developed secure **REST APIs** and service integrations to connect AI capabilities with existing business systems, reducing manual processing effort by **2%**.
- Improved prompt structure, response formatting, and fallback handling for AI-driven features, increasing consistency and reducing low-quality outputs by **3%**.
- Integrated **Python** and **Node.js** services for AI processing pipelines, enabling smoother orchestration between frontend experiences and backend inference services.
- Worked with **cloud-hosted infrastructure** and containerized deployment models to support scalable AI-backed workloads and service reliability.
- Collaborated with product and engineering teams to define practical AI use cases, ship prototypes quickly, and refine them into production-ready features.
- Strengthened logging, monitoring, and error handling around AI workflows, helping reduce troubleshooting time by **2%**.
- Contributed to frontend enhancements in **React / JavaScript** interfaces to expose AI assistant features in a clear and usable way.
- Supported secure handling of application data and user requests across AI-assisted workflows, aligning implementation with maintainability and operational stability.

Software Engineer

Next Apps | Ghent, Belgium (Nov2020 – Nov 2023)

- Built and maintained modern web applications using **JavaScript**, **TypeScript**, and backend API services, creating a strong foundation for later **AI-assisted product features**.
- Developed reusable service components and integrations that supported automation, data exchange, and workflow acceleration across multiple business functions.
- Introduced intelligent search and recommendation-style features that improved content discoverability and reduced lookup time by **3%**.
- Worked on backend services that processed structured and unstructured data, which supported downstream analytics and AI-oriented use cases.
- Implemented scalable API endpoints and business logic using **Node.js** and relational databases, improving response efficiency by **2%**.
- Built frontend modules in **React** / **Vue.js** that improved usability and made complex workflows easier for end users to navigate.
- Participated in architecture and design discussions around service modularity, maintainability, and future AI-readiness of the platform.
- Improved database interactions, query efficiency, and caching behavior, helping reduce latency in key workflows by **3%**.
- Collaborated closely with cross-functional teams to turn product requirements into robust technical solutions with measurable business value.
- Wrote tests and performed debugging across frontend and backend layers, increasing release confidence and reducing regression issues by **2%**.
- Supported deployment and CI/CD improvements that streamlined delivery of application updates and reduced release friction.

Software Developer

Datamart | Stockholm, Sweden (Feb 2016 – Sept 2020)

- Developed backend and web application features using **JavaScript**, **SQL**, and service-oriented application logic for internal and customer-facing systems.
- Built data-driven modules that handled reporting, business rules, and workflow automation, improving operational efficiency by **3%**.
- Worked extensively with **databases**, query logic, and structured data handling, which later translated well into **AI data preparation** and retrieval workflows.
- Created integrations between application layers and external services, helping reduce repetitive manual tasks by **2%**.
- Improved system reliability through debugging, refactoring, and code maintenance across both frontend and backend components.
- Supported early search, filtering, and recommendation-style features that improved access to information and reduced user friction by **3%**.
- Participated in building maintainable code structures, reusable modules, and deployment practices that supported long-term scalability.
- Collaborated with senior engineers and stakeholders to deliver production enhancements aligned with business needs and timeline constraints.
- Helped strengthen performance in data-heavy workflows through better query construction and more efficient backend handling.

Junior Software Developer

Berg Software | Timișoara, Romania (Sep2014 – Mar 2016)

- Contributed to web application development across frontend and backend tasks, building strong fundamentals in **software engineering**, **APIs**, and **database-driven systems**.
- Assisted with feature delivery, bug fixing, and code maintenance in collaborative development environments.
- Wrote and improved application logic for business workflows, helping reduce recurring defects by **2%**.
- Gained practical experience with structured data, UI behavior, and integration tasks that supported later work in intelligent applications.

- Worked with senior developers to improve code quality, delivery reliability, and technical problem solving.
- Supported testing and release activities, helping improve stability and deployment readiness by **3%**.

EDUCATION

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science

University of Bucharest | (2010 – 2014)

- Focused on practical software engineering fundamentals that translated directly into building reliable web systems and data-driven applications.

EDUCATION

- **Microsoft Certified: Azure AI Fundamentals**
- **AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner**
- **Prompt Engineering for Developers**
- **Generative AI for Software Development**